

Character-Specific Rubrics

Derived from each character's top 10 strongest questions

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Caiden Rubric

Core skills: planning, sequencing, budgeting, time management, tradeoff reasoning

Gold criteria (from top 10 patterns)

- Embeds planning, sequencing, budgeting, time management, tradeoff reasoning in scenario and/or stem
- Scenario ~54+ words with concrete, scenario-specific clues
- Zero quality flags; balanced distractor lengths
- Requires reading — not answerable from generic SEL or common sense alone
- Four-option model: best / plausible-incomplete / plausible-flawed / realistic-wrong
- Correct answer position not predictable by length or slot

What makes a 5/5 question

- Multi-step plan under time or resource constraints (minutes, tokens, budget)
- Stem asks which plan, order, or tradeoff fits ALL constraints in the scenario
- Distractors: plans that forget one constraint, rush without checking totals, or skip a step
- Hardest character path — difficulty 5/5 with quantitative reasoning

What makes a 4/5 question

- Meets grade-band difficulty (4/5) with clear character skill focus
- At most one minor heuristic flag that does not harm fairness
- Scenario provides enough context; distractors are plausible

What makes a 3/5 question

- K–1: age-appropriate recognition or simple cause/effect (expected floor)
- Upper bands at 3/5: missing character skill depth or quality flags — needs review

What should NEVER appear

- Upper-band questions with no numbers, time limits, or planning constraints
- Pure emotion/regulation items without executive-function demand
- Single-step recall when grade band expects multi-step tradeoffs
- SEL-only stems with no sequencing, budgeting, or time logic (grades 4+)
- Joke or impossible distractors
- Correct answer dramatically longer than all distractors
- Question solvable without reading the scenario
- Duplicate scenario framing text repeated multiple times

Distractor guidelines

- One distractor ignores a time or quantity constraint
- One distractor sequences steps in a plausible but wrong order
- One distractor solves an easier sub-problem but misses the full plan

Grade-band notes

- K-1: Simple planning recognition; difficulty ceiling ~3/5
- 2-3: Introduce planning and sequencing with one clear decision
- 4-5: Comparison and inference; target 4–5/5 for Caiden
- 6-8: Multi-step tradeoff reasoning; target 4–5/5

Rubric Violations

Total violations: 16 (critical: 0, review: 16)

Caiden — Review items (16)

1. cq2-45-q3 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
2. cq3-45-q3 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
3. cq4-45-q2 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
4. cq5-45-q1 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
5. cq7-45-q2 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
6. cq8-45-q5 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
7. cq9-45-q1 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
8. cq9-45-q4 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
9. cq9-45-q7 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
10. cq1-45-q1 (4-5, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
11. cq6-45-q3 (4-5, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
12. cq6-45-q6 (4-5, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
13. cq7-45-q5 (4-5, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
14. cq7-45-q8 (4-5, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
15. cq8-45-q2 (4-5, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
16. cq8-45-q8 (4-5, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)

Miranda Rubric

Core skills: evidence, clues, passage analysis, inference

Gold criteria (from top 10 patterns)

- Embeds evidence, clues, passage analysis, inference in scenario and/or stem
- Scenario ~74+ words with concrete, scenario-specific clues
- Zero quality flags; balanced distractor lengths
- Requires reading — not answerable from generic SEL or common sense alone
- Four-option model: best / plausible-incomplete / plausible-flawed / realistic-wrong
- Correct answer position not predictable by length or slot

What makes a 5/5 question

- Passage with at least two concrete clues supporting the correct inference
- Stem: “According to the passage...” or “Which clue best supports...”
- Distractors: true but weaker evidence, related off-topic facts, plausible misreadings
- Answer changes if a key passage sentence is removed

What makes a 4/5 question

- Meets grade-band difficulty (4/5) with clear character skill focus
- At most one minor heuristic flag that does not harm fairness
- Scenario provides enough context; distractors are plausible

What makes a 3/5 question

- K–1: age-appropriate recognition or simple cause/effect (expected floor)
- Upper bands at 3/5: missing character skill depth or quality flags — needs review

What should NEVER appear

- Answers guessable without rereading the passage
- Stems that do not reference evidence, clues, or passage details
- Pure “who/where/when” recall at grades 6–8 without inference
- Distractors unrelated to passage content
- Joke or impossible distractors
- Correct answer dramatically longer than all distractors
- Question solvable without reading the scenario
- Duplicate scenario framing text repeated multiple times

Distractor guidelines

- One distractor cites a true passage detail that does not support the conclusion
- One distractor over-infers beyond what the text says
- One distractor is plausible if the reader skims but not if they reread

Grade-band notes

- K-1: Simple evidence recognition; difficulty ceiling ~3/5
- 2-3: Introduce evidence and clues with one clear decision
- 4-5: Comparison and inference; target 4–5/5 for Miranda
- 6-8: Multi-step inference; target 4–5/5

Rubric Violations

Total violations: 0 (critical: 0, review: 0)

Zeke Rubric

Core skills: teamwork, leadership, social reasoning, collaboration tradeoffs

Gold criteria (from top 10 patterns)

- Embeds teamwork, leadership, social reasoning, collaboration tradeoffs in scenario and/or stem
- Scenario ~68+ words with concrete, scenario-specific clues
- Zero quality flags; balanced distractor lengths
- Requires reading — not answerable from generic SEL or common sense alone
- Four-option model: best / plausible-incomplete / plausible-flawed / realistic-wrong
- Correct answer position not predictable by length or slot

What makes a 5/5 question

- Group scenario with competing needs; leadership choice affects everyone
- Stem asks which move helps the team without ignoring anyone
- Two distractors are emotionally plausible team mistakes; one is realistic but too narrow
- No cartoon selfish “obvious wrong” options

What makes a 4/5 question

- Meets grade-band difficulty (4/5) with clear character skill focus
- At most one minor heuristic flag that does not harm fairness
- Scenario provides enough context; distractors are plausible

What makes a 3/5 question

- K–1: age-appropriate recognition or simple cause/effect (expected floor)
- Upper bands at 3/5: missing character skill depth or quality flags — needs review

What should NEVER appear

- Cartoonishly selfish wrong answers (“ignore everyone,” “only care about yourself”)
- Leadership questions with no team or group context
- Only one emotionally plausible option — rest are obvious jokes
- Conflict resolution without a realistic collaboration tradeoff
- Joke or impossible distractors
- Correct answer dramatically longer than all distractors
- Question solvable without reading the scenario
- Duplicate scenario framing text repeated multiple times

Distractor guidelines

- Two distractors are realistic group-leadership mistakes
- One distractor helps one person but sidelines others
- Avoid making the correct answer the only kind option

Grade-band notes

K-1: Simple teamwork recognition; difficulty ceiling ~3/5

2-3: Introduce teamwork and leadership with one clear decision

4-5: Comparison and inference; target 4–5/5 for Zeke

6-8: Multi-step collaboration tradeoffs; target 4–5/5

Rubric Violations

Total violations: 2 (critical: 2, review: 0)

Critical / priority review

1. zkm1-68-q3 — The New Table (6-8) • 3/5

- Audit flag: lacks_reasoning_skill
- Below character gold bar (3/5; target 4–5/5 for 6-8)

2. zkm6-68-q2 — The Courage Challenge (6-8) • 3/5

- Audit flag: lacks_reasoning_skill
- Below character gold bar (3/5; target 4–5/5 for 6-8)

Charlie Rubric

Core skills: experimentation, variables, observation, scientific thinking

Gold criteria (from top 10 patterns)

- Embeds experimentation, variables, observation, scientific thinking in scenario and/or stem
- Scenario ~69+ words with concrete, scenario-specific clues
- Zero quality flags; balanced distractor lengths
- Requires reading — not answerable from generic SEL or common sense alone
- Four-option model: best / plausible-incomplete / plausible-flawed / realistic-wrong
- Correct answer position not predictable by length or slot

What makes a 5/5 question

- Fair-test setup: one variable changes, others held constant
- Stem asks what to observe, predict, or change next in the experiment
- Distractors: change wrong variable, skip observation, or draw conclusion too early
- Scientific vocabulary appropriate to grade band

What makes a 4/5 question

- Meets grade-band difficulty (4/5) with clear character skill focus
- At most one minor heuristic flag that does not harm fairness
- Scenario provides enough context; distractors are plausible

What makes a 3/5 question

- K–1: age-appropriate recognition or simple cause/effect (expected floor)
- Upper bands at 3/5: missing character skill depth or quality flags — needs review

What should NEVER appear

- Silly science distractors (“science is over forever,” magic explanations)
- Changing two variables at once without fair-test framing
- Conclusions before observation
- Non-scientific reasoning dressed as science (pure opinion)
- Joke or impossible distractors
- Correct answer dramatically longer than all distractors
- Question solvable without reading the scenario
- Duplicate scenario framing text repeated multiple times

Distractor guidelines

- One distractor changes the wrong variable
- One distractor skips the observation step
- One distractor is a common kid misconception, not a joke

Grade-band notes

- K-1: Simple experimentation recognition; difficulty ceiling ~3/5
- 2-3: Introduce experimentation and variables with one clear decision
- 4-5: Comparison and inference; target 4–5/5 for Charlie
- 6-8: Multi-step scientific thinking; target 4–5/5

Rubric Violations

Total violations: 0 (critical: 0, review: 0)

B-4 Rubric

Core skills: emotions, regulation, self-awareness, coping strategies

Gold criteria (from top 10 patterns)

- Embeds emotions, regulation, self-awareness, coping strategies in scenario and/or stem
- Scenario ~78+ words with concrete, scenario-specific clues
- Zero quality flags; balanced distractor lengths
- Requires reading — not answerable from generic SEL or common sense alone
- Four-option model: best / plausible-incomplete / plausible-flawed / realistic-wrong
- Correct answer position not predictable by length or slot

What makes a 5/5 question

- Body signals !' name feeling !' compare two regulation strategies
- Stem compares coping steps or strategies for the named feeling
- Distractors: strategy applied too early, helps partially but ignores body signals, or avoids naming
- Warm tone; no shaming language

What makes a 4/5 question

- Meets grade-band difficulty (4/5) with clear character skill focus
- At most one minor heuristic flag that does not harm fairness
- Scenario provides enough context; distractors are plausible

What makes a 3/5 question

- K–1: age-appropriate recognition or simple cause/effect (expected floor)
- Upper bands at 3/5: missing character skill depth or quality flags — needs review

What should NEVER appear

- Skipping body-signal !' name-feeling !' strategy sequence (grades 2+)
- Only extreme negative distractors with one obviously positive correct answer
- Regulation strategies applied before naming the feeling (as correct answer)
- Emotion labeling without any coping comparison
- Joke or impossible distractors
- Correct answer dramatically longer than all distractors
- Question solvable without reading the scenario
- Duplicate scenario framing text repeated multiple times

Distractor guidelines

- One distractor uses a calm strategy before naming the feeling
- One distractor helps a little but ignores body signals
- One distractor avoids the feeling rather than regulating it

Grade-band notes

- K-1: Simple emotions recognition; difficulty ceiling ~3/5
- 2-3: Introduce emotions and regulation with one clear decision
- 4-5: Comparison and inference; target 4–5/5 for B-4
- 6-8: Multi-step coping strategies; target 4–5/5

Rubric Violations

Total violations: 16 (critical: 0, review: 16)

B-4 — Review items (16)

1. b4m1-45-q3 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
2. b4m2-45-q2 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
3. b4m3-45-q1 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
4. b4m4-45-q3 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
5. b4m5-45-q3 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
6. b4m6-45-q2 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
7. b4m7-45-q1 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
8. b4m8-45-q3 (4-5, 4/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
9. b4m1-68-q1 (6-8, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
10. b4m2-68-q3 (6-8, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
11. b4m3-68-q2 (6-8, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
12. b4m4-68-q1 (6-8, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
13. b4m5-68-q1 (6-8, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
14. b4m6-68-q3 (6-8, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
15. b4m7-68-q2 (6-8, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)
16. b4m8-68-q1 (6-8, 5/5): Stem lacks character-appropriate reasoning cue (compare, evidence, plan, etc.)